

HC Services — People Code

Section 5: Expense Claims & Reimbursement Policy

Section 5.0: Document Control

Document Reference: HC-PC-005

Version: 3.0

Effective Date: 1 January 2026

Status: current

Owner: Finance Division and People & Culture Division

Version	Effective from	Superseded on	What changed
3.0	1 January 2026	—	Approval thresholds at \$5.7.2 raised. Claim is assessed under the version in force on the date the expense was incurred .
2.4	1 January 2025	31 December 2025	Thresholds AED 1,000 / 5,000. Retained in full at \$5.9.

Section 5.1: Policy Scope

This policy applies to all employees incurring expenditure on Company business. It is owned jointly by Finance and People & Culture; where the two differ on a point of interpretation, Finance prevails on matters of amount and People & Culture on matters of eligibility (HC-PC-007 §7.1).

Section 5.2: General Principles

5.2.1 Prior Authorisation

Prior written authorisation from the line manager is required before incurring any single expense exceeding **AED 500**. The internet allowance at HC-PC-004 §4.6.2 is expressly exempt.

5.2.2 Submission Deadline

Claims must be submitted within **30 calendar days** of the date the expense was incurred. Claims submitted later may be declined at the discretion of Finance.

5.2.3 Evidence

Every claim requires an itemised receipt. A card statement is not a receipt.

Section 5.3: Travel Expenses

5.3.1 Booking

Travel is booked through the Company travel desk using **Form FIN-T-01** (HC-PC-007 §7.9). Self-booked travel is reimbursed only up to the fare the travel desk would have obtained.

5.3.2 Cabin Class

Domestic flights are Economy for all grades. For international flights:

Flight duration	Grades 1–5	Grade 6 and above
Under 5 hours	Economy	Economy
5 hours or more	Economy	Business

Grade bands are defined at HC-PC-007 §7.6. Eligibility follows **grade, not seniority of title**.

5.3.3 Accommodation

Nightly caps exclude taxes and municipality fees:

City tier	Nightly cap (AED)	Maximum nights without VP approval
Dubai / Abu Dhabi	750	5
Other UAE	500	5
MENA region	600	7
Europe / USA	900	7
Other international	700	10

5.3.4 Ground Transport

Taxis and ride-hailing are reimbursable. Personal vehicle use is reimbursed at **AED 0.67 per kilometre**, with distance evidence.

Section 5.4: Daily Allowances (Per Diem)

Per diem covers meals and incidentals and is paid for each **full day** away, and for the day of departure. It is **not** payable for the day of return:

Location	Per diem (AED/day)	Payable on return day
Within UAE	150	No
MENA region	250	No
Europe / USA	350	No
Other international	280	No

Worked example. An employee departing Monday and returning Thursday from London claims per diem for Monday, Tuesday and Wednesday — three days at AED 350 = **AED 1,050**. Thursday is the return day and is not payable.

Section 5.5: Entertainment & Client Hospitality

5.5.1 Client Meals

Client entertainment is reimbursable up to **AED 250 per head**, including the employee. The claim must name every attendee.

5.5.2 Alcohol

Alcohol is reimbursable only where a client is present and only up to 25% of the total bill.

Section 5.6: Non-Reimbursable Expenses

The following are never reimbursable: traffic and parking fines; personal grooming; gym and health club membership; in-flight purchases other than meals; hotel minibar; and personal travel insurance. A claim for a non-reimbursable item is rejected with a reference to this section and may be appealed under HC-PC-009 §9.2.

Section 5.7: Submission & Payment Process

5.7.1 Submission

Claims are submitted through the Omni Expense portal with receipts attached. This is the route for the internet allowance under HC-PC-004 §4.6.2. It is not the route for the education allowance, which is claimed under HC-PC-012 §12.5 and does not pass through this portal at all.

5.7.2 Approval Thresholds

The approval required depends on the total value of the claim, assessed under the version of this policy in force on the **date the expense was incurred** (§5.0):

Claim total (AED)	Approval required
Under 1,500	Line manager
1,500 – 7,500	Line manager and Finance
Above 7,500	Line manager, Finance, and the Chief Financial Officer

An employee may not approve their own claim, nor a claim from which they benefit.

Worked example. A claim for AED 4,000 incurred on 15 February 2026 falls in the middle band and needs the line manager and Finance. The same AED 4,000 incurred on 15 November 2025 would fall under the superseded thresholds at §5.9 — above AED 1,000 but below AED 5,000 — and would have needed the same two approvers. A claim for AED 1,200 reverses the result: line manager only today, line manager and Finance in 2025.

5.7.3 Payment

Approved claims are paid with the next payroll run, provided approval completes 5 working days before the payroll cut-off.

Section 5.8: Fraud & Misuse

Submitting a claim for an expense not incurred, inflating an amount, or submitting a receipt for a personal expense is **gross misconduct** under HC-PC-006 §6.4.

Section 5.9: Appendix A — Superseded Provisions (Version 2.4)

SUPERSEDED — DO NOT APPLY TO EXPENSES INCURRED ON OR AFTER 1 JANUARY 2026. The provision below was in force from 1 January 2025 to 31 December 2025 under Version 2.4. The provision currently in force is §5.7.2. This appendix is retained because a claim is assessed under the version in force on the date the expense was incurred.

A.1 Approval Thresholds (Version 2.4, in force 1 January 2025 – 31 December 2025)

Claim total (AED)	Approval required
Under 1,000	Line manager
1,000 – 5,000	Line manager and Finance

Claim total (AED)	Approval required
Above 5,000	Line manager, Finance, and the Chief Financial Officer

For queries about this policy, contact People & Culture at people@hcservices.ae or raise a query via the HCS Concierge.